

FOR WHOEVER'S WATCHING THEM

Pet Sitter Emergency & Routine Binder

Everything a sitter needs to know, in one place

Fill it out once, hand it off with confidence —
every time you're away.

FORM & FERN

Pet Profile

The basics, all in one place for a sitter meeting your pet for the first time.

- ☐ Name, breed or mix, age, and weight
- ☐ Microchip number and registry, if known
- ☐ Spayed/neutered status
- ☐ Any known allergies or sensitivities
- ☐ Current medications and supplements, if any
- ☐ Personality in a few words — shy, social, independent, velcro
- ☐ Favorite toy, spot, or activity
- ☐ Anything that scares or startles them
- ☐ A recent photo attached or saved somewhere easy to find

Daily Routine Schedule

Keeping the routine consistent is the single biggest thing a sitter can do right.

- ☐ Morning wake-up and first outdoor break time
- ☐ Feeding times and which meals happen when
- ☐ Walk times, length, and preferred route
- ☐ Midday check-in or break, if applicable
- ☐ Evening feeding and final outdoor break time
- ☐ Bedtime routine — crate, specific room, or free roam
- ☐ Any daily medication times built into the schedule
- ☐ Playtime or enrichment expectations
- ☐ Anything different about weekends vs. weekdays

Feeding Instructions

Be specific — sitters can't guess portion sizes or food swaps correctly.

- ☐ Food brand and exact type (wet, dry, raw, prescription)
- ☐ Exact amount per meal, in cups or grams
- ☐ Where food and treats are stored
- ☐ Approved treats and how many per day
- ☐ Foods that are strictly off-limits for this pet
- ☐ Water bowl location and how often it's refreshed
- ☐ Any feeding quirks — slow feeder, food guarding, picky eating
- ☐ What to do if they skip a meal (see What To Do If page for more)
- ☐ Whether other pets in the home need to be fed separately

Medication Instructions

Leave blank if not applicable — never guess dosages or timing.

- ☐ Medication name and exact dose
- ☐ Time(s) of day it's given
- ☐ How it's given — in food, pill pocket, by hand
- ☐ Where the medication is stored
- ☐ What it's for, in simple terms
- ☐ What a missed dose situation should look like — call owner or vet first
- ☐ Any side effects to watch for
- ☐ Refill information if the sitter's stay is longer than the supply
- ☐ Prescribing vet's name and contact info

Behavior, Quirks & Triggers

The things you'd tell a friend if they were watching your pet for the first time.

- ☐ What tends to stress or startle them
- ☐ What reliably calms them down
- ☐ How they react to strangers at the door
- ☐ How they do around other animals
- ☐ Any resource guarding around food, toys, or space
- ☐ Noise sensitivities — thunderstorms, fireworks, vacuum, etc.
- ☐ Separation habits — do they settle quickly or take time
- ☐ Any commands or cues they respond to best
- ☐ One thing that always makes them happy

Leash & Walking Notes

For anyone taking them outside — walks, potty breaks, or the yard.

- ☐ Preferred leash, harness, or collar and how it's fastened
- ☐ Whether they pull, and any technique that helps
- ☐ Reactivity to other dogs, people, bikes, or cars
- ☐ Favorite walking route or park, if any
- ☐ Off-leash reliability — yes, no, or only in a fenced area
- ☐ How they signal needing a bathroom break
- ☐ Weather considerations — heat, cold, or paw sensitivity
- ☐ What to do if they slip a collar or leash (see What To Do If page)
- ☐ Whether they're comfortable meeting other dogs on walks

House Access Instructions

The practical logistics of getting in, staying comfortable, and locking up.

- ☐ How to get in — key location, lockbox code, or garage code
- ☐ Alarm system code and how to arm/disarm it
- ☐ Wifi network name and password
- ☐ Thermostat instructions and preferred temperature range
- ☐ Trash and recycling day, if the sitter's stay overlaps
- ☐ Mail or package handling instructions
- ☐ Rooms or areas that are off-limits
- ☐ Where cleaning supplies and pet-mess supplies are kept
- ☐ Any neighbors who know a sitter will be coming and going

Emergency Contacts

Fill this out before you leave and post it somewhere visible.

- ☐ Regular vet clinic name, phone number, and address
- ☐ Nearest 24-hour emergency animal hospital and phone number
- ☐ Pet insurance provider and policy number, if applicable
- ☐ Owner's cell phone and best way to reach them while away
- ☐ A trusted local backup contact if the owner is unreachable
- ☐ Building manager or landlord contact, if relevant
- ☐ Poison control or animal poison hotline number
- ☐ Where the pet carrier is kept, for emergency transport
- ☐ Any standing authorization for the sitter to approve emergency vet care

What To Do If... (Scenario Guide)

A few common situations, so a sitter isn't guessing under pressure.

- ☐ They won't eat a meal: note it, try once more later, call if it continues past 24 hours
- ☐ They seem lethargic or "off": note specifics and call the owner to discuss
- ☐ They vomit once but seem otherwise fine: monitor, note it, mention at pickup
- ☐ They get loose or escape: check known hiding/favorite spots first, then notify owner immediately
- ☐ A medication dose is missed: do not double up — call the owner or vet for guidance
- ☐ There's a knock at the door from someone unexpected: don't let the pet near the door unsupervised
- ☐ Severe weather hits during a walk: head home immediately, prioritize safety over finishing the route
- ☐ Something seems seriously wrong: go to the emergency vet listed above, then call the owner

Sitter's Daily Log

A quick daily note back to the owner — meals, walks, mood, anything worth mentioning.

- ☐ Date and which visit or day this covers
- ☐ Meals given and how much was eaten
- ☐ Walks or outdoor time completed
- ☐ Medication given, if applicable
- ☐ General mood and energy level today
- ☐ Anything unusual noticed today
- ☐ Anything the sitter needs from the owner
- ☐ A quick highlight from today worth sharing
- ☐ Confirmed the home was left secure after the visit

House Rules & Boundaries

The small preferences that make a sitter's stay feel like it matches how you actually live.

- ☐ Furniture and bed access — allowed or not, and where
- ☐ Whether the pet is allowed in the kitchen during meal prep
- ☐ Rules around guests visiting during the sitter's stay
- ☐ Whether the pet can be left alone, and for how long
- ☐ Preferred way to handle nail trims, brushing, or grooming touch-ups
- ☐ How to handle visitors at the door — greet, crate, or separate room
- ☐ Any household member (human or pet) with special handling needs
- ☐ Preferred bedtime routine for the pet
- ☐ Anything the owner considers a hard no

Departure & Return Checklist

A simple checklist for the owner, before leaving and right after getting back.

- ☐ Left enough food, treats, and any medication for the full stay
- ☐ Filled in every page of this binder before the sitter arrives
- ☐ Introduced the sitter to the pet in person if this is their first visit
- ☐ Shared this binder and all access codes with the sitter
- ☐ Confirmed the sitter's contact info and check-in schedule
- ☐ Left a copy of this binder both printed and saved digitally
- ☐ On return: checked in with the sitter about how the stay went
- ☐ On return: reviewed the sitter's daily log entries
- ☐ On return: thanked the sitter and noted anything for next time